

2

ENVIRONMENT SETUP AND THE COMMAND LINE



Environment setup is the process of organizing your computer so you can write code. This involves installing any necessary tools, configuring them, and handling any hiccups during the setup. There is no single setup process because everyone has a different computer with a different operating system, version of the operating system, and version of the Python interpreter. Even so, this chapter describes some basic concepts to help you administer your own computer using the command line, environment variables, and filesystem.

Learning these concepts and tools might seem like a headache. You want to write code, not poke around configuration settings or understand inscrutable console commands. But these skills will save you time in the long run. Ignoring error messages or randomly changing configuration